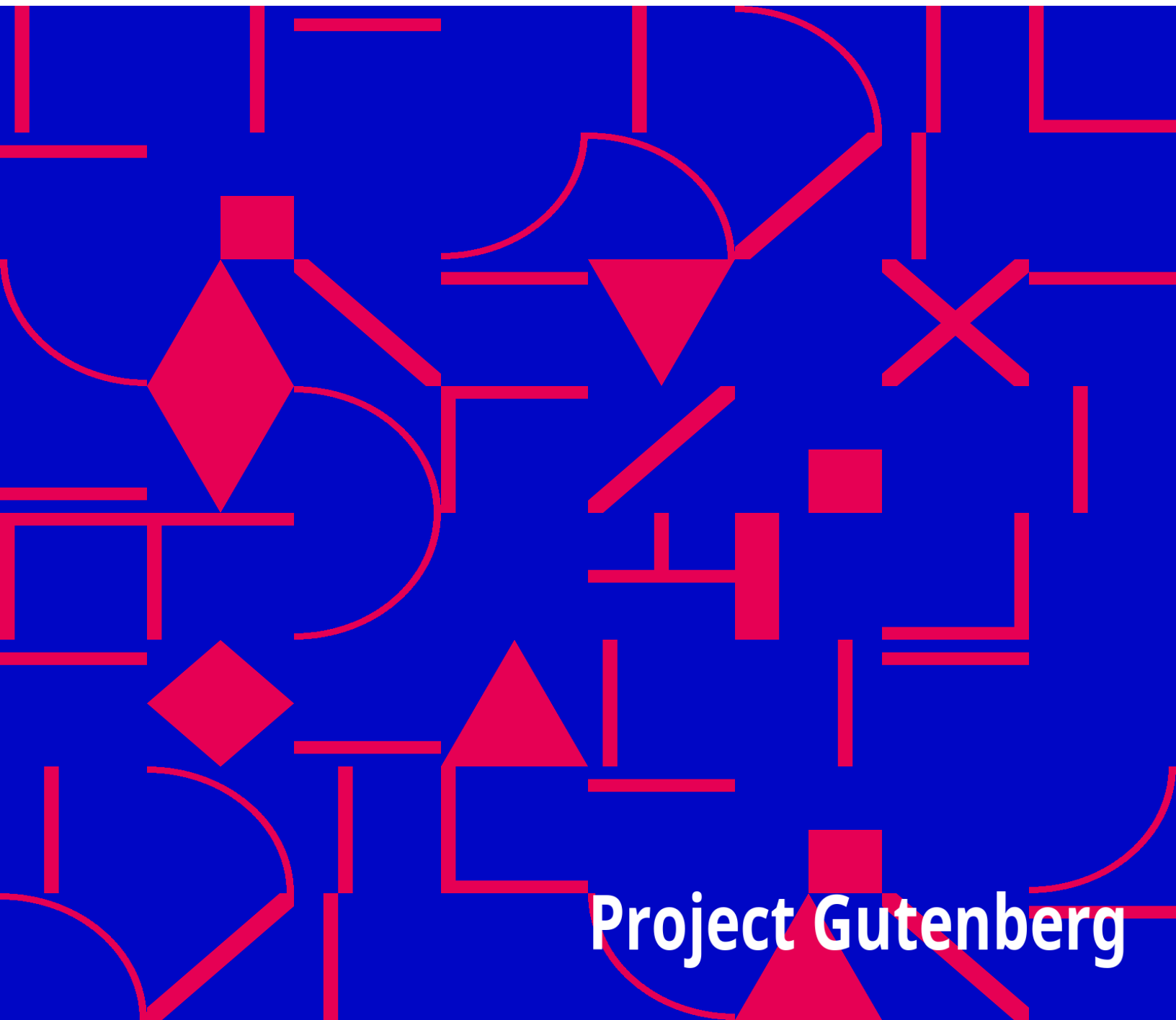


The Bible, King James version, Book 15: Ezra

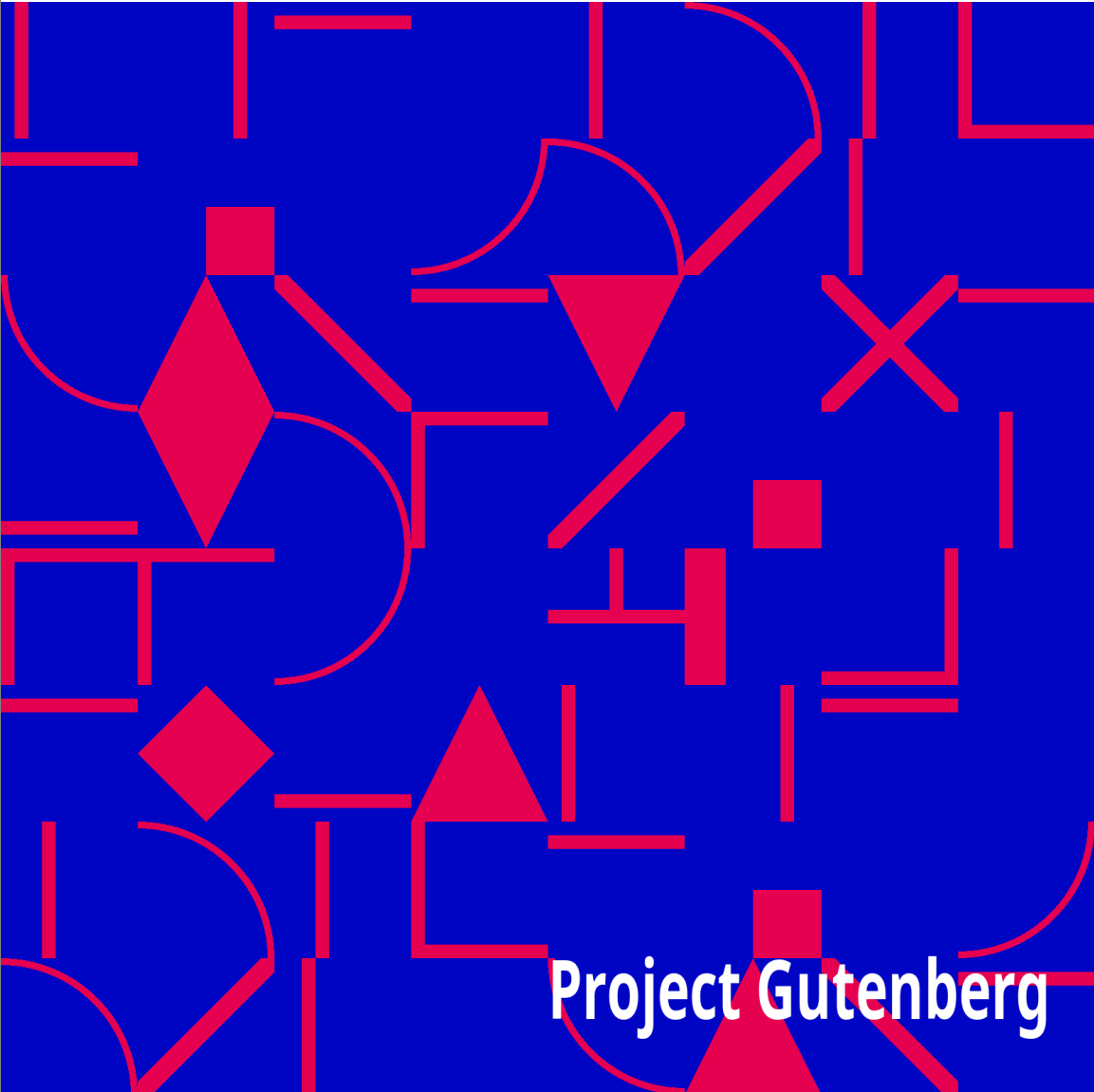
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Book 15 Ezra

15:001:001 Now in the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, that the word of the LORD by the mouth of Jeremiah might be fulfilled, the LORD stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of Persia, that he made a proclamation throughout all his kingdom, and put it also in writing, saying,

15:001:002 Thus saith Cyrus king of Persia, The LORD God of heaven hath given me all the kingdoms of the earth; and he hath charged me to build him an house at Jerusalem, which is in Judah.

15:001:003 Who is there among you of all his people? his God be with him,

and let him go up to Jerusalem, which is in Judah, and build the house of the LORD God of Israel, (he is the God,) which is in Jerusalem.

15:001:004 And whosoever remaineth in any place where he sojourneth, let

the men of his place help him with silver, and with gold, and with goods, and with beasts, beside the freewill offering for the house of God that is in Jerusalem.

15:001:005 Then rose up the chief of the fathers of Judah and Benjamin,
and the priests, and the Levites, with all them whose spirit
God had raised, to go up to build the house of the LORD which
is in Jerusalem.

15:001:006 And all they that were about them strengthened their hands
with vessels of silver, with gold, with goods, and with
beasts, and with precious things, beside all that was
willingly offered.

15:001:007 Also Cyrus the king brought forth the vessels of the house of
the LORD, which Nebuchadnezzar had brought forth out of
Jerusalem, and had put them in the house of his gods;

15:001:008 Even those did Cyrus king of Persia bring forth by the hand
of
Mithredath the treasurer, and numbered them unto Sheshbazzar,
the prince of Judah.

15:001:009 And this is the number of them: thirty chargers of gold, a
thousand chargers of silver, nine and twenty knives,

15:001:010 Thirty basons of gold, silver basons of a second sort four
hundred and ten, and other vessels a thousand.

15:001:011 All the vessels of gold and of silver were five thousand and
four hundred. All these did Sheshbazzar bring up with them of the captivity
that were brought up from Babylon unto Jerusalem.

15:002:001 Now these are the children of the province that went up out
of the captivity, of those which had been carried away, whom

Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried away unto Babylon, and came again unto Jerusalem and Judah, every one unto his city;

15:002:002 Which came with Zerubbabel: Jeshua, Nehemiah, Seraiah, Reelaiah, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mizpar, Bigvai, Rehum, Baanah. The number of the men of the people of Israel:

15:002:003 The children of Parosh, two thousand an hundred seventy and two.

15:002:004 The children of Shephatiah, three hundred seventy and two.

15:002:005 The children of Arah, seven hundred seventy and five.

15:002:006 The children of Pahathmoab, of the children of Jeshua and Joab, two thousand eight hundred and twelve.

15:002:007 The children of Elam, a thousand two hundred fifty and four.

15:002:008 The children of Zattu, nine hundred forty and five.

15:002:009 The children of Zaccai, seven hundred and threescore.

15:002:010 The children of Bani, six hundred forty and two.

15:002:011 The children of Bebai, six hundred twenty and three.

15:002:012 The children of Azgad, a thousand two hundred twenty and two.

15:002:013 The children of Adonikam, six hundred sixty and six.

15:002:014 The children of Bigvai, two thousand fifty and six.

- 15:002:015 The children of Adin, four hundred fifty and four.
- 15:002:016 The children of Ater of Hezekiah, ninety and eight.
- 15:002:017 The children of Bezai, three hundred twenty and three.
- 15:002:018 The children of Jorah, an hundred and twelve.
- 15:002:019 The children of Hashum, two hundred twenty and three.
- 15:002:020 The children of Gibbar, ninety and five.
- 15:002:021 The children of Bethlehem, an hundred twenty and three.
- 15:002:022 The men of Netophah, fifty and six.
- 15:002:023 The men of Anathoth, an hundred twenty and eight.
- 15:002:024 The children of Azmaveth, forty and two.
- 15:002:025 The children of Kirjatharim, Chephirah, and Beeroth, seven hundred and forty and three.
- 15:002:026 The children of Ramah and Gaba, six hundred twenty and one.
- 15:002:027 The men of Michmas, an hundred twenty and two.
- 15:002:028 The men of Bethel and Ai, two hundred twenty and three.
- 15:002:029 The children of Nebo, fifty and two.
- 15:002:030 The children of Magbish, an hundred fifty and six.

15:002:031 The children of the other Elam, a thousand two hundred fifty and four.

15:002:032 The children of Harim, three hundred and twenty.

15:002:033 The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono, seven hundred twenty and five.

15:002:034 The children of Jericho, three hundred forty and five.

15:002:035 The children of Senaah, three thousand and six hundred and thirty.

15:002:036 The priests: the children of Jedaiah, of the house of Jeshua, nine hundred seventy and three.

15:002:037 The children of Immer, a thousand fifty and two.

15:002:038 The children of Pashur, a thousand two hundred forty and seven.

15:002:039 The children of Harim, a thousand and seventeen.

15:002:040 The Levites: the children of Jeshua and Kadmiel, of the children of Hodaviah, seventy and four.

15:002:041 The singers: the children of Asaph, an hundred twenty and eight.

15:002:042 The children of the porters: the children of Shallum, the children of Ater, the children of Talmon, the children of Akkub, the children of Hatita, the children of Shobai, in all an hundred thirty and nine.

15:002:043 The Nethinims: the children of Ziha, the children of Hasupha,
the children of Tabbaoth,

15:002:044 The children of Keros, the children of Siaha, the children of
Padon,

15:002:045 The children of Lebanah, the children of Hagabah, the
children
of Akkub,

15:002:046 The children of Hagab, the children of Shalmal, the children
of Hanan,

15:002:047 The children of Giddel, the children of Gahar, the children of
Reaiah,

15:002:048 The children of Rezin, the children of Nekoda, the children
of
Gazzam,

15:002:049 The children of Uzza, the children of Paseah, the children of
Besai,

15:002:050 The children of Asnah, the children of Mehunim, the children
of Nephusim,

15:002:051 The children of Bakbuk, the children of Hakupha, the
children
of Harhur,

15:002:052 The children of Bazluth, the children of Mehida, the children
of Harsha,

15:002:053 The children of Barkos, the children of Sisera, the children of Thamah,

15:002:054 The children of Neziah, the children of Hatipha.

15:002:055 The children of Solomon's servants: the children of Sotai, the children of Sophereth, the children of Peruda,

15:002:056 The children of Jaalah, the children of Darkon, the children of Giddel,

15:002:057 The children of Shephatiah, the children of Hattil, the children of Pochereth of Zebaim, the children of Ami.

15:002:058 All the Nethinims, and the children of Solomon's servants, were three hundred ninety and two.

15:002:059 And these were they which went up from Telmelah, Telharsa, Cherub, Addan, and Immer: but they could not shew their father's house, and their seed, whether they were of Israel:

15:002:060 The children of Delaiah, the children of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda, six hundred fifty and two.

15:002:061 And of the children of the priests: the children of Habaiah, the children of Koz, the children of Barzillai; which took a wife of the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite, and was called after their name:

15:002:062 These sought their register among those that were reckoned by genealogy, but they were not found: therefore were they, as polluted, put from the priesthood.

15:002:063 And the Tirshatha said unto them, that they should not eat of the most holy things, till there stood up a priest with Urim and with Thummim.

15:002:064 The whole congregation together was forty and two thousand three hundred and threescore,

15:002:065 Beside their servants and their maids, of whom there were seven thousand three hundred thirty and seven: and there were among them two hundred singing men and singing women.

15:002:066 Their horses were seven hundred thirty and six; their mules, two hundred forty and five;

15:002:067 Their camels, four hundred thirty and five; their asses, six thousand seven hundred and twenty.

15:002:068 And some of the chief of the fathers, when they came to the house of the LORD which is at Jerusalem, offered freely for the house of God to set it up in his place:

15:002:069 They gave after their ability unto the treasure of the work threescore and one thousand drams of gold, and five thousand pound of silver, and one hundred priests' garments.

15:002:070 So the priests, and the Levites, and some of the people, and the singers, and the porters, and the Nethinims, dwelt in their cities, and all Israel in their cities.

15:003:001 And when the seventh month was come, and the children of Israel were in the cities, the people gathered themselves together as one man to Jerusalem.

15:003:002 Then stood up Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and his brethren the priests, and Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and his brethren, and builded the altar of the God of Israel, to offer burnt offerings thereon, as it is written in the law of Moses the man of God.

15:003:003 And they set the altar upon his bases; for fear was upon them because of the people of those countries: and they offered burnt offerings thereon unto the LORD, even burnt offerings morning and evening.

15:003:004 They kept also the feast of tabernacles, as it is written, and offered the daily burnt offerings by number, according to the custom, as the duty of every day required;

15:003:005 And afterward offered the continual burnt offering, both of the new moons, and of all the set feasts of the LORD that were consecrated, and of every one that willingly offered a freewill offering unto the LORD.

15:003:006 From the first day of the seventh month began they to offer burnt offerings unto the LORD. But the foundation of the temple of the LORD was not yet laid.

15:003:007 They gave money also unto the masons, and to the carpenters; and meat, and drink, and oil, unto them of Zidon, and to them of Tyre, to bring cedar trees from Lebanon to the sea of Joppa, according to the grant that they had of Cyrus king of Persia.

15:003:008 Now in the second year of their coming unto the house of God at Jerusalem, in the second month, began Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and the remnant of their brethren the priests and the Levites, and all they that were come out of the captivity unto Jerusalem; and appointed the Levites, from twenty years old and upward, to set forward the work of the house of the LORD.

15:003:009 Then stood Jeshua with his sons and his brethren, Kadmiel and

his sons, the sons of Judah, together, to set forward the workmen in the house of God: the sons of Henadad, with their sons and their brethren the Levites.

15:003:010 And when the builders laid the foundation of the temple of the

LORD, they set the priests in their apparel with trumpets, and the Levites the sons of Asaph with cymbals, to praise the LORD, after the ordinance of David king of Israel.

15:003:011 And they sang together by course in praising and giving thanks unto the LORD; because he is good, for his mercy endureth for ever toward Israel. And all the people shouted with a great shout, when they praised the LORD, because the foundation of the house of the LORD was laid.

15:003:012 But many of the priests and Levites and chief of the fathers, who were ancient men, that had seen the first house, when the foundation of this house was laid before their eyes, wept with a loud voice; and many shouted aloud for joy:

15:003:013 So that the people could not discern the noise of the shout of joy from the noise of the weeping of the people: for the people shouted with a loud shout, and the noise was heard afar off.

15:004:001 Now when the adversaries of Judah and Benjamin heard that the children of the captivity builded the temple unto the LORD God of Israel;

15:004:002 Then they came to Zerubbabel, and to the chief of the fathers, and said unto them, Let us build with you: for we seek your God, as ye do; and we do sacrifice unto him since the days of Esarhaddon king of Assur, which brought us up hither.

15:004:003 But Zerubbabel, and Jeshua, and the rest of the chief of the fathers of Israel, said unto them, Ye have nothing to do with us to build an house unto our God; but we ourselves together will build unto the LORD God of Israel, as king Cyrus the king of Persia hath commanded us.

15:004:004 Then the people of the land weakened the hands of the people of Judah, and troubled them in building,

15:004:005 And hired counsellors against them, to frustrate their purpose, all the days of Cyrus king of Persia, even until the reign of Darius king of Persia.

15:004:006 And in the reign of Ahasuerus, in the beginning of his reign, wrote they unto him an accusation against the inhabitants of Judah and Jerusalem.

15:004:007 And in the days of Artaxerxes wrote Bishlam, Mithredath, Tabeel, and the rest of their companions, unto Artaxerxes king of Persia; and the writing of the letter was written in the Syrian tongue, and interpreted in the Syrian tongue.

15:004:008 Rehum the chancellor and Shimshai the scribe wrote a letter against Jerusalem to Artaxerxes the king in this sort:

15:004:009 Then wrote Rehum the chancellor, and Shimshai the scribe, and the rest of their companions; the Dinaites, the Apharsathchites, the

Tarpelites, the Apharsites, the Archevites, the Babylonians, the Susanchites, the Dehavites, and the Elamites,

15:004:010 And the rest of the nations whom the great and noble Asnapper

brought over, and set in the cities of Samaria, and the rest that are on this side the river, and at such a time.

15:004:011 This is the copy of the letter that they sent unto him, even unto Artaxerxes the king; Thy servants the men on this side the river, and at such a time.

15:004:012 Be it known unto the king, that the Jews which came up from thee to us are come unto Jerusalem, building the rebellious and the bad city, and have set up the walls thereof, and joined the foundations.

15:004:013 Be it known now unto the king, that, if this city be builded, and the walls set up again, then will they not pay toll, tribute, and custom, and so thou shalt endamage the revenue of the kings.

15:004:014 Now because we have maintenance from the king's palace, and it was not meet for us to see the king's dishonour, therefore have we sent and certified the king;

15:004:015 That search may be made in the book of the records of thy fathers: so shalt thou find in the book of the records, and know that this city is a rebellious city, and hurtful unto kings and provinces, and that they have moved sedition within the same of old time: for which cause was this city destroyed.

15:004:016 We certify the king that, if this city be builded again, and the walls thereof set up, by this means thou shalt have no portion on this side the river.

15:004:017 Then sent the king an answer unto Rehum the chancellor, and to Shimshai the scribe, and to the rest of their companions that dwell in Samaria, and unto the rest beyond the river, Peace, and at such a time.

15:004:018 The letter which ye sent unto us hath been plainly read before me.

15:004:019 And I commanded, and search hath been made, and it is found

that this city of old time hath made insurrection against kings, and that rebellion and sedition have been made therein.

15:004:020 There have been mighty kings also over Jerusalem, which have

ruled over all countries beyond the river; and toll, tribute, and custom, was paid unto them.

15:004:021 Give ye now commandment to cause these men to cease, and that

this city be not builded, until another commandment shall be given from me.

15:004:022 Take heed now that ye fail not to do this: why should damage grow to the hurt of the kings?

15:004:023 Now when the copy of king Artaxerxes' letter was read before Rehum, and Shimshai the scribe, and their companions, they went up

in haste to Jerusalem unto the Jews, and made them to cease by force and power.

15:004:024 Then ceased the work of the house of God which is at Jerusalem. So it ceased unto the second year of the reign of Darius king of Persia.

15:005:001 Then the prophets, Haggai the prophet, and Zechariah the son of Iddo, prophesied unto the Jews that were in Judah and Jerusalem in the name of the God of Israel, even unto them.

15:005:002 Then rose up Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and began to build the house of God which is at Jerusalem: and with them were the prophets of God helping them.

15:005:003 At the same time came to them Tatnai, governor on this side the river, and Shetharboznai and their companions, and said thus unto them, Who hath commanded you to build this house, and to make up this wall?

15:005:004 Then said we unto them after this manner, What are the names of the men that make this building?

15:005:005 But the eye of their God was upon the elders of the Jews, that they could not cause them to cease, till the matter came to Darius: and then they returned answer by letter concerning this matter.

15:005:006 The copy of the letter that Tatnai, governor on this side the river, and Shetharboznai and his companions the Apharsachites, which were on this side the river, sent unto Darius the king:

15:005:007 They sent a letter unto him, wherein was written thus; Unto Darius the king, all peace.

15:005:008 Be it known unto the king, that we went into the province of Judea, to the house of the great God, which is builded with great stones, and timber is laid in the walls, and this work goeth fast on, and prospereth in their hands.

15:005:009 Then asked we those elders, and said unto them thus, Who commanded you to build this house, and to make up these walls?

15:005:010 We asked their names also, to certify thee, that we might write the names of the men that were the chief of them.

15:005:011 And thus they returned us answer, saying, We are the servants of the God of heaven and earth, and build the house that was builded these many years ago, which a great king of Israel builded and set up.

15:005:012 But after that our fathers had provoked the God of heaven unto wrath, he gave them into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, the Chaldean, who destroyed this house, and carried the people away into Babylon.

15:005:013 But in the first year of Cyrus the king of Babylon the same king Cyrus made a decree to build this house of God.

15:005:014 And the vessels also of gold and silver of the house of God, which Nebuchadnezzar took out of the temple that was in Jerusalem, and brought them into the temple of Babylon, those did Cyrus the king take out

of the temple of Babylon, and they were delivered unto one, whose name was Sheshbazzar, whom he had made governor;

15:005:015 And said unto him, Take these vessels, go, carry them into the temple that is in Jerusalem, and let the house of God be builded in his place.

15:005:016 Then came the same Sheshbazzar, and laid the foundation of the house of God which is in Jerusalem: and since that time even until now hath it been in building, and yet it is not finished.

15:005:017 Now therefore, if it seem good to the king, let there be search made in the king's treasure house, which is there at Babylon, whether it be so, that a decree was made of Cyrus the king to build this house of God at Jerusalem, and let the king send his pleasure to us concerning this matter.

15:006:001 Then Darius the king made a decree, and search was made in the

house of the rolls, where the treasures were laid up in
Babylon.

15:006:002 And there was found at Achmetha, in the palace that is in the province of the Medes, a roll, and therein was a record thus written:

15:006:003 In the first year of Cyrus the king the same Cyrus the king made a decree concerning the house of God at Jerusalem, Let the house be builded, the place where they offered sacrifices, and let the foundations thereof be strongly laid; the height thereof threescore cubits, and the breadth thereof threescore cubits;

15:006:004 With three rows of great stones, and a row of new timber: and let the expenses be given out of the king's house:

15:006:005 And also let the golden and silver vessels of the house of God, which Nebuchadnezzar took forth out of the temple which is at Jerusalem, and brought unto Babylon, be restored, and brought again unto the temple which is at Jerusalem, every one to his place, and place them in the house of God.

15:006:006 Now therefore, Tatnai, governor beyond the river, Shetharboznai, and your companions the Apharsachites, which are beyond the river, be ye far from thence:

15:006:007 Let the work of this house of God alone; let the governor of the Jews and the elders of the Jews build this house of God in his place.

15:006:008 Moreover I make a decree what ye shall do to the elders of these Jews for the building of this house of God: that of the king's goods, even of the tribute beyond the river, forthwith expenses be given unto these men, that they be not hindered.

15:006:009 And that which they have need of, both young bullocks, and rams, and lambs, for the burnt offerings of the God of heaven, wheat, salt, wine, and oil, according to the appointment of the priests which are at Jerusalem, let it be given them day by day without fail:

15:006:010 That they may offer sacrifices of sweet savours unto the God of heaven, and pray for the life of the king, and of his sons.

15:006:011 Also I have made a decree, that whosoever shall alter this word, let timber be pulled down from his house, and being set

up, let him be hanged thereon; and let his house be made a dunghill for this.

15:006:012 And the God that hath caused his name to dwell there destroy all kings and people, that shall put to their hand to alter and to destroy this house of God which is at Jerusalem. I Darius have made a decree; let it be done with speed.

15:006:013 Then Tatnai, governor on this side the river, Shetharboznai, and their companions, according to that which Darius the king had sent, so they did speedily.

15:006:014 And the elders of the Jews builded, and they prospered through the prophesying of Haggai the prophet and Zechariah the son of Iddo. And they builded, and finished it, according to the commandment of the God of Israel, and according to the commandment of Cyrus, and Darius, and Artaxerxes king of Persia.

15:006:015 And this house was finished on the third day of the month Adar, which was in the sixth year of the reign of Darius the king.

15:006:016 And the children of Israel, the priests, and the Levites, and the rest of the children of the captivity, kept the dedication of this house of God with joy.

15:006:017 And offered at the dedication of this house of God an hundred bullocks, two hundred rams, four hundred lambs; and for a sin offering for all Israel, twelve he goats, according to the number of the tribes of Israel.

15:006:018 And they set the priests in their divisions, and the Levites in their courses, for the service of God, which is at Jerusalem; as it is written in the book of Moses.

15:006:019 And the children of the captivity kept the passover upon the fourteenth day of the first month.

15:006:020 For the priests and the Levites were purified together, all of them were pure, and killed the passover for all the children of the captivity, and for their brethren the priests, and for themselves.

15:006:021 And the children of Israel, which were come again out of captivity, and all such as had separated themselves unto them from the filthiness of the heathen of the land, to seek the LORD God of Israel, did eat,

15:006:022 And kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days with joy: for the LORD had made them joyful, and turned the heart of the king of Assyria unto them, to strengthen their hands in the work of the house of God, the God of Israel.

15:007:001 Now after these things, in the reign of Artaxerxes king of Persia, Ezra the son of Seraiah, the son of Azariah, the son of Hilkiah,

15:007:002 The son of Shallum, the son of Zadok, the son of Ahitub,

15:007:003 The son of Amariah, the son of Azariah, the son of Meraioth,

15:007:004 The son of Zerahiah, the son of Uzzi, the son of Bukki,

15:007:005 The son of Abishua, the son of Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the chief priest:

15:007:006 This Ezra went up from Babylon; and he was a ready scribe in

the law of Moses, which the LORD God of Israel had given: and the king granted him all his request, according to the hand of the LORD his God upon him.

15:007:007 And there went up some of the children of Israel, and of the priests, and the Levites, and the singers, and the porters, and the Nethinims, unto Jerusalem, in the seventh year of Artaxerxes the king.

15:007:008 And he came to Jerusalem in the fifth month, which was in the seventh year of the king.

15:007:009 For upon the first day of the first month began he to go up from Babylon, and on the first day of the fifth month came he to Jerusalem, according to the good hand of his God upon him.

15:007:010 For Ezra had prepared his heart to seek the law of the LORD, and to do it, and to teach in Israel statutes and judgments.

15:007:011 Now this is the copy of the letter that the king Artaxerxes gave unto Ezra the priest, the scribe, even a scribe of the words of the commandments of the LORD, and of his statutes to Israel.

15:007:012 Artaxerxes, king of kings, unto Ezra the priest, a scribe of the law of the God of heaven, perfect peace, and at such a time.

15:007:013 I make a decree, that all they of the people of Israel, and of his priests and Levites, in my realm, which are minded of their own freewill to go up to Jerusalem, go with thee.

15:007:014 Forasmuch as thou art sent of the king, and of his seven counsellors, to enquire concerning Judah and Jerusalem, according to the law of thy God which is in thine hand;

15:007:015 And to carry the silver and gold, which the king and his counsellors have freely offered unto the God of Israel, whose habitation is in Jerusalem,

15:007:016 And all the silver and gold that thou canst find in all the province of Babylon, with the freewill offering of the people, and of the priests, offering willingly for the house of their God which is in Jerusalem:

15:007:017 That thou mayest buy speedily with this money bullocks, rams, lambs, with their meat offerings and their drink offerings, and offer them upon the altar of the house of your God which is in Jerusalem.

15:007:018 And whatsoever shall seem good to thee, and to thy brethren, to do with the rest of the silver and the gold, that do after the will of your God.

15:007:019 The vessels also that are given thee for the service of the house of thy God, those deliver thou before the God of Jerusalem.

15:007:020 And whatsoever more shall be needful for the house of thy God, which thou shalt have occasion to bestow, bestow it out of the king's treasure house.

15:007:021 And I, even I Artaxerxes the king, do make a decree to all the treasurers which are beyond the river, that whatsoever Ezra the priest, the scribe of the law of the God of heaven, shall require of you, it be done speedily,

15:007:022 Unto an hundred talents of silver, and to an hundred measures of wheat, and to an hundred baths of wine, and to an hundred baths of oil, and salt without prescribing how much.

15:007:023 Whatsoever is commanded by the God of heaven, let it be diligently done for the house of the God of heaven: for why should there be wrath against the realm of the king and his sons?

15:007:024 Also we certify you, that touching any of the priests and Levites, singers, porters, Nethinims, or ministers of this house of God, it shall not be lawful to impose toll, tribute, or custom, upon them.

15:007:025 And thou, Ezra, after the wisdom of thy God, that is in thine hand, set magistrates and judges, which may judge all the people that are beyond the river, all such as know the laws of thy God; and teach ye them that know them not.

15:007:026 And whosoever will not do the law of thy God, and the law of
the king, let judgment be executed speedily upon him, whether it be unto death, or to banishment, or to confiscation of goods, or to imprisonment.

15:007:027 Blessed be the LORD God of our fathers, which hath put such a thing as this in the king's heart, to beautify the house of the LORD

which is in Jerusalem:

15:007:028 And hath extended mercy unto me before the king, and his counsellors, and before all the king's mighty princes. And I was strengthened as the hand of the LORD my God was upon me, and I gathered together out of Israel chief men to go up with me.

15:008:001 These are now the chief of their fathers, and this is the genealogy of them that went up with me from Babylon, in the reign of Artaxerxes the king.

15:008:002 Of the sons of Phinehas; Gershom: of the sons of Ithamar; Daniel: of the sons of David; Hattush.

15:008:003 Of the sons of Shechaniah, of the sons of Pharosh; Zechariah: and with him were reckoned by genealogy of the males an hundred and fifty.

15:008:004 Of the sons of Pahathmoab; Elihoenai the son of Zerahiah, and
with him two hundred males.

15:008:005 Of the sons of Shechaniah; the son of Jahaziel, and with him three hundred males.

15:008:006 Of the sons also of Adin; Ebed the son of Jonathan, and with him fifty males.

15:008:007 And of the sons of Elam; Jeshaiah the son of Athaliah, and with him seventy males.

15:008:008 And of the sons of Shephatiah; Zebadiah the son of Michael, and with him fourscore males.

15:008:009 Of the sons of Joab; Obadiah the son of Jehiel, and with him two hundred and eighteen males.

15:008:010 And of the sons of Shelomith; the son of Josiphiah, and with him an hundred and threescore males.

15:008:011 And of the sons of Bebai; Zechariah the son of Bebai, and with him twenty and eight males.

15:008:012 And of the sons of Azgad; Johanan the son of Hakkatan, and with him an hundred and ten males.

15:008:013 And of the last sons of Adonikam, whose names are these, Eliphelet, Jeiel, and Shemaiah, and with them threescore males.

15:008:014 Of the sons also of Bigvai; Uthai, and Zabbud, and with them seventy males.

15:008:015 And I gathered them together to the river that runneth to Ahava; and there abode we in tents three days: and I viewed the people, and the priests, and found there none of the sons of Levi.

15:008:016 Then sent I for Eliezer, for Ariel, for Shemaiah, and for Elnathan, and for Jarib, and for Elnathan, and for Nathan, and for Zechariah, and for Meshullam, chief men; also for Joiarib, and for Elnathan, men of understanding.

15:008:017 And I sent them with commandment unto Iddo the chief at the place Casiphia, and I told them what they should say unto Iddo, and to his brethren the Nethinims, at the place Casiphia, that they should bring unto us ministers for the house of our God.

15:008:018 And by the good hand of our God upon us they brought us a man of understanding, of the sons of Mahli, the son of Levi, the son of Israel; and Sherebiah, with his sons and his brethren, eighteen;

15:008:019 And Hashabiah, and with him Jeshaiah of the sons of Merari, his brethren and their sons, twenty;

15:008:020 Also of the Nethinims, whom David and the princes had appointed for the service of the Levites, two hundred and twenty Nethinims: all of them were expressed by name.

15:008:021 Then I proclaimed a fast there, at the river of Ahava, that we might afflict ourselves before our God, to seek of him a right way for us, and for our little ones, and for all our substance.

15:008:022 For I was ashamed to require of the king a band of soldiers and horsemen to help us against the enemy in the way: because we had spoken unto the king, saying, The hand of our God is upon all them for good that seek him; but his power and his wrath is against all them that forsake him.

15:008:023 So we fasted and besought our God for this: and he was intreated of us.

15:008:024 Then I separated twelve of the chief of the priests, Sherebiah, Hashabiah, and ten of their brethren with them,

15:008:025 And weighed unto them the silver, and the gold, and the vessels, even the offering of the house of our God, which the king, and his counsellors, and his lords, and all Israel there present, had offered:

15:008:026 I even weighed unto their hand six hundred and fifty talents of silver, and silver vessels an hundred talents, and of gold an hundred

talents;

15:008:027 Also twenty basons of gold, of a thousand drams; and two vessels of fine copper, precious as gold.

15:008:028 And I said unto them, Ye are holy unto the LORD; the vessels are holy also; and the silver and the gold are a freewill offering unto the LORD God of your fathers.

15:008:029 Watch ye, and keep them, until ye weigh them before the chief of the priests and the Levites, and chief of the fathers of Israel, at Jerusalem, in the chambers of the house of the LORD.

15:008:030 So took the priests and the Levites the weight of the silver, and the gold, and the vessels, to bring them to Jerusalem unto the house of our God.

15:008:031 Then we departed from the river of Ahava on the twelfth day of the first month, to go unto Jerusalem: and the hand of our God was upon us, and he delivered us from the hand of the enemy, and of such as lay in wait by the way.

15:008:032 And we came to Jerusalem, and abode there three days.

15:008:033 Now on the fourth day was the silver and the gold and the vessels weighed in the house of our God by the hand of Meremoth the son of Uriah the priest; and with him was Eleazar the son of Phinehas; and with them was Jozabad the son of Jeshua, and Noadiah the son of Binnui, Levites;

15:008:034 By number and by weight of every one: and all the weight was written at that time.

15:008:035 Also the children of those that had been carried away, which were come out of the captivity, offered burnt offerings unto the God of Israel, twelve bullocks for all Israel, ninety and six rams, seventy and seven lambs, twelve he goats for a sin offering: all this was a burnt offering unto the LORD.

15:008:036 And they delivered the king's commissions unto the king's lieutenants, and to the governors on this side the river: and they furthered the people, and the house of God.

15:009:001 Now when these things were done, the princes came to me, saying, The people of Israel, and the priests, and the Levites, have not separated themselves from the people of the lands, doing according to their abominations, even of the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Jebusites, the Ammonites, the Moabites, the Egyptians, and the Amorites.

15:009:002 For they have taken of their daughters for themselves, and for their sons: so that the holy seed have mingled themselves with the people of those lands: yea, the hand of the princes and rulers hath been chief in this trespass.

15:009:003 And when I heard this thing, I rent my garment and my mantle, and plucked off the hair of my head and of my beard, and sat down astonished.

15:009:004 Then were assembled unto me every one that trembled at the words of the God of Israel, because of the transgression of those that had been carried away; and I sat astonished until the evening sacrifice.

15:009:005 And at the evening sacrifice I arose up from my heaviness; and

having rent my garment and my mantle, I fell upon my knees,
and spread out my hands unto the LORD my God,

15:009:006 And said, O my God, I am ashamed and blush to lift up my
face

to thee, my God: for our iniquities are increased over our
head, and our trespass is grown up unto the heavens.

15:009:007 Since the days of our fathers have we been in a great trespass
unto this day; and for our iniquities have we, our kings, and our priests,
been delivered into the hand of the kings of the lands, to the sword, to
captivity, and to a spoil, and to confusion of face, as it is this day.

15:009:008 And now for a little space grace hath been shewed from the
LORD our God, to leave us a remnant to escape, and to give us a nail in his
holy place, that our God may lighten our eyes, and give us a little reviving
in our bondage.

15:009:009 For we were bondmen; yet our God hath not forsaken us in
our bondage, but hath extended mercy unto us in the sight of the kings of
Persia, to give us a reviving, to set up the house of our God, and to repair
the desolations thereof, and to give us a wall in Judah and in Jerusalem.

15:009:010 And now, O our God, what shall we say after this? for we
have forsaken thy commandments,

15:009:011 Which thou hast commanded by thy servants the prophets,
saying, The land, unto which ye go to possess it, is an
unclean land with the filthiness of the people of the lands,
with their abominations, which have filled it from one end to
another with their uncleanness.

15:009:012 Now therefore give not your daughters unto their sons,
neither

take their daughters unto your sons, nor seek their peace or
their wealth for ever: that ye may be strong, and eat the good
of the land, and leave it for an inheritance to your children
for ever.

15:009:013 And after all that is come upon us for our evil deeds, and for
our great trespass, seeing that thou our God hast punished us
less than our iniquities deserve, and hast given us such
deliverance as this;

15:009:014 Should we again break thy commandments, and join in
affinity

with the people of these abominations? wouldest not thou be
angry with us till thou hadst consumed us, so that there
should be no remnant nor escaping?

15:009:015 O LORD God of Israel, thou art righteous: for we remain yet
escaped, as it is this day: behold, we are before thee in our trespasses: for
we cannot stand before thee because of this.

15:010:001 Now when Ezra had prayed, and when he had confessed,
weeping

and casting himself down before the house of God, there
assembled unto him out of Israel a very great congregation of
men and women and children: for the people wept very sore.

15:010:002 And Shechaniah the son of Jehiel, one of the sons of Elam,
answered and said unto Ezra, We have trespassed against our
God, and have taken strange wives of the people of the land:
yet now there is hope in Israel concerning this thing.

15:010:003 Now therefore let us make a covenant with our God to put away all the wives, and such as are born of them, according to the counsel of my lord, and of those that tremble at the commandment of our God; and let it be done according to the law.

15:010:004 Arise; for this matter belongeth unto thee: we also will be with thee: be of good courage, and do it.

15:010:005 Then arose Ezra, and made the chief priests, the Levites, and all Israel, to swear that they should do according to this word. And they sware.

15:010:006 Then Ezra rose up from before the house of God, and went into the chamber of Johanan the son of Eliashib: and when he came thither, he did eat no bread, nor drink water: for he mourned because of the transgression of them that had been carried away.

15:010:007 And they made proclamation throughout Judah and Jerusalem unto all the children of the captivity, that they should gather themselves together unto Jerusalem;

15:010:008 And that whosoever would not come within three days, according to the counsel of the princes and the elders, all his substance should be forfeited, and himself separated from the congregation of those that had been carried away.

15:010:009 Then all the men of Judah and Benjamin gathered themselves together unto Jerusalem within three days. It was the ninth month, on the twentieth day of the month; and all the people sat in the street of the house of God, trembling because of this matter, and for the great rain.

15:010:010 And Ezra the priest stood up, and said unto them, Ye have transgressed, and have taken strange wives, to increase the trespass of Israel.

15:010:011 Now therefore make confession unto the LORD God of your fathers, and do his pleasure: and separate yourselves from the people of the land, and from the strange wives.

15:010:012 Then all the congregation answered and said with a loud voice,

As thou hast said, so must we do.

15:010:013 But the people are many, and it is a time of much rain, and we are not able to stand without, neither is this a work of one day or two: for we are many that have transgressed in this thing.

15:010:014 Let now our rulers of all the congregation stand, and let all them which have taken strange wives in our cities come at appointed times, and with them the elders of every city, and the judges thereof, until the fierce wrath of our God for this matter be turned from us.

15:010:015 Only Jonathan the son of Asahel and Jahaziah the son of Tikvah were employed about this matter: and Meshullam and Shabbethai the Levite helped them.

15:010:016 And the children of the captivity did so. And Ezra the priest, with certain chief of the fathers, after the house of their fathers, and all of them by their names, were separated, and sat down in the first day of the tenth month to examine the matter.

15:010:017 And they made an end with all the men that had taken strange wives by the first day of the first month.

15:010:018 And among the sons of the priests there were found that had taken strange wives: namely, of the sons of Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and his brethren; Maaseiah, and Eliezer, and Jarib, and Gedaliah.

15:010:019 And they gave their hands that they would put away their wives; and being guilty, they offered a ram of the flock for their trespass.

15:010:020 And of the sons of Immer; Hanani, and Zebadiah.

15:010:021 And of the sons of Harim; Maaseiah, and Elijah, and Shemaiah,
and Jehiel, and Uzziah.

15:010:022 And of the sons of Pashur; Elioenai, Maaseiah, Ishmael,
Nethaneel, Jozabad, and Elasah.

15:010:023 Also of the Levites; Jozabad, and Shimei, and Kelaiah, (the same is Kelita,) Pethahiah, Judah, and Eliezer.

15:010:024 Of the singers also; Eliashib: and of the porters; Shallum,
and Telem, and Uri.

15:010:025 Moreover of Israel: of the sons of Parosh; Ramiah, and Jeziah, and Malchiah, and Miamin, and Eleazar, and Malchijah, and Benaiah.

15:010:026 And of the sons of Elam; Mattaniah, Zechariah, and Jehiel,
and
Abdi, and Jeremoth, and Eliah.

15:010:027 And of the sons of Zattu; Elioenai, Eliashib, Mattaniah, and Jeremoth, and Zabad, and Aziza.

15:010:028 Of the sons also of Bebai; Jehohanan, Hananiah, Zabbai, and Athlai.

15:010:029 And of the sons of Bani; Meshullam, Malluch, and Adaiah, Jashub, and Sheal, and Ramoth.

15:010:030 And of the sons of Pahathmoab; Adna, and Chelal, Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattaniah, Bezaleel, and Binnui, and Manasseh.

15:010:031 And of the sons of Harim; Eliezer, Ishijah, Malchiah, Shemaiah, Shimeon,

15:010:032 Benjamin, Malluch, and Shemariah.

15:010:033 Of the sons of Hashum; Mattenai, Mattathah, Zabad, Eliphelet, Jeremai, Manasseh, and Shimei.

15:010:034 Of the sons of Bani; Maadai, Amram, and Uel,

15:010:035 Benaiah, Bedeiah, Chelluh,

15:010:036 Vaniah, Meremoth, Eliashib,

15:010:037 Mattaniah, Mattenai, and Jaasau,

15:010:038 And Bani, and Binnui, Shimei,

15:010:039 And Shelemiah, and Nathan, and Adaiah,

15:010:040 Machnadebai, Shashai, Sharai,

15:010:041 Azareel, and Shelemiah, Shemariah,

15:010:042 Shallum, Amariah, and Joseph.

15:010:043 Of the sons of Nebo; Jeiel, Mattithiah, Zabad, Zebina, Jadau,
and Joel, Benaiah.

15:010:044 All these had taken strange wives: and some of them had
wives
by whom they had children.

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